

U.S. Restaurants

McDonald's Corp

Rating

Market-Perform

Price Target

⊖ MCD

295.00 USD



Danilo Gargiulo

+1 917 344 8475

danilo.gargiulo@bernsteinsg.com

McDonald's (MCD): What to expect from Investor Day

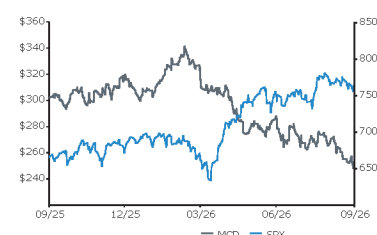
McDonald's will host its first Investor Day since 2023 on September 23 in Chicago, offering investors a front-row look at the strategy shaping its 'Next' chapter. Ahead of this event, we have connected with franchisees and management and this note provides our thoughts on what we believe investors could expect on the day.

We believe that the ultimate message of the day will be McDonald's transition from growth to sustainability and efficiency, centered around the four key pillars of the new strategy: 1) menu innovation, 2) value and consumer engagement, 3) the Restaurant Next remodel cycle, and 4) the people and franchisee capabilities needed to execute the vision. We expect the day to feature presentations, menu showcases, technology demonstrations, and a tour of a new U.S. drive-thru prototype and incorporate financial and KPI targets similar in structure to those shared in 2023. On **menu**, we expect MCD to unveil a broader "hand-breaded" chicken platform spanning multiple products that we assume will be launched in late 2027. Similarly, we expect a *global* rollout of beverages following the launch in the US. We believe the international uplift from menu could exceed the domestic opportunity given the relatively less intense competitive landscape (e.g., lack of scaled competitors specialized in dirty sodas, energy drinks, and made-to-order chicken). We believe the menu revamp could help accelerate the comps, but we are looking forward to understanding how McDonald's plans to mitigate the risk of added operational complexity and gain global alignment with franchisees given incremental investments required, at a time when franchisees' cashflows (while still healthy) have compressed. On **consumer**, we expect MCD to update investors on a new EDLP value construct aligned with franchisees, and a revamped marketing strategy that expands focus on social media / influencers (consumer-led ads, co-creations etc.). On **restaurant**, we are looking forward to gaining visibility on the new drive-thru prototype (featuring more vivid colors and play areas) and remodel benefits, as management enhances digital capabilities and AI-enabled technology in stores, and operating improvements designed to enhance throughput and the customer experience. We believe franchisees will be investing \$500K-\$1M per restaurant with 20%+ contribution from MCD and that the remodel cycle will be global and spread over 4-5 years. We believe that the combined effect of the store uplifts and menu innovation could contribute to a sustainable LSD% SSS growth at MCD, while we expect that the contribution of new stores to Systemwide sales growth to reduce from the current 2.5% target to 2%. On the **people** side, we expect MCD to share insights on how they plan to elevate hospitality and leverage scale to support franchisees more efficiently. We expect management to target G&A to be (cont. on next page)

Close Date	17 Sep 2026
MCD Close Price (USD)	248.48
Price Target (USD)	295.00
Upside/(Downside)	19%
52-Week Range	341.75/247.83
SPX	7,637.76
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	3.1%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	175,835
EV (USD) (M)	229,605
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	(18.7) (6.4) (23.8) (18.5)
SPX (%)	11.6 (1.4) 13.7 15.7
Relative (%)	(30.3) (5.0) (37.6) (34.2)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
MCD (USD)	12.20	12.53	13.55	EBITDA (M)	14,592	15,436	16,472	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	20.4	19.8	18.3

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

First Published: 18 Sep 2026 09:00 UTC Completion Date: 18 Sep 2026 03:02 UTC

www.bernsteinresearch.com

< 2% of Systemwide sales (from current target of 2.2%) over the course of the next 3 years.

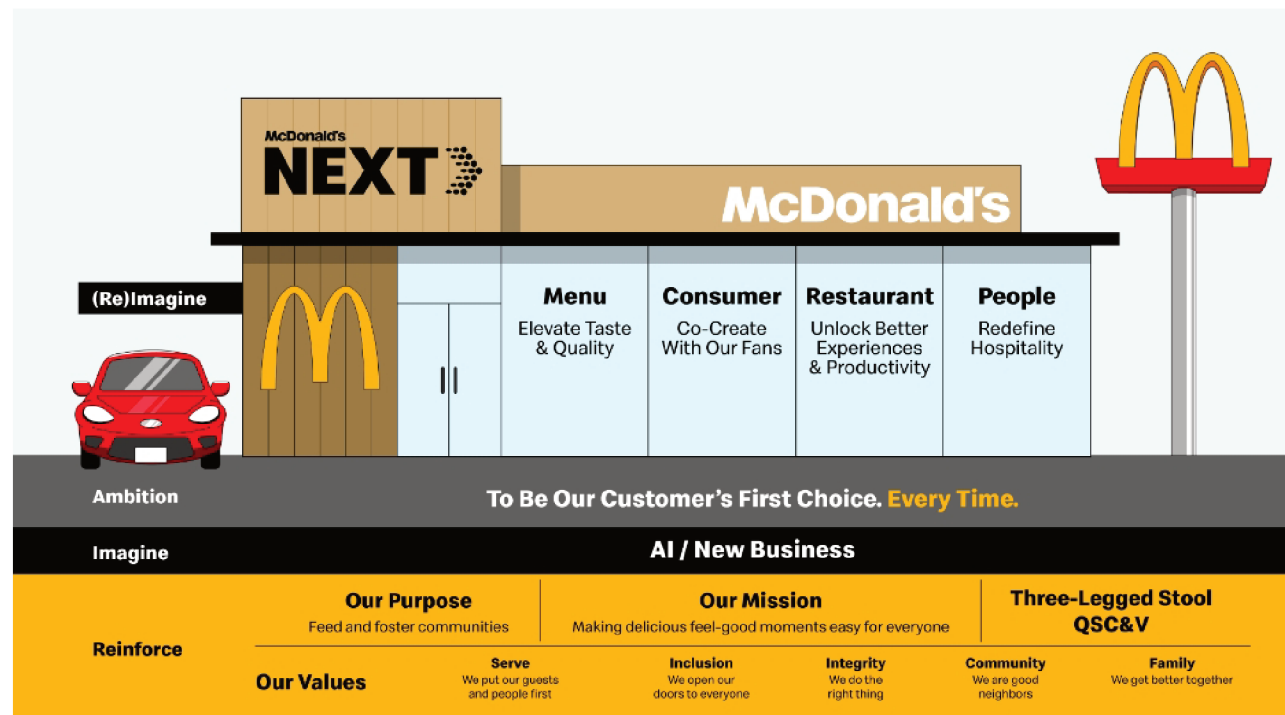
Ultimately, Investor Day could give investors a compelling new framework for translating these initiatives into more sustainable earnings growth. Our base scenario assumes that MCD will target LSD% SSSG and 2% new store contribution to SWS growth, resulting in 4% revenue growth, operating margins in the high-40s or low-50s, annual CAPEX increases of \$400M - \$600M, and unchanged capital allocation priority. We expect this would translate into an EPS growth of 7-8% and that the multiple could re-rate to 18.5x, resulting in 10-15% improvement of the stock. Our conversations with investors suggest that the sentiment into the investor day is fairly bearish, indicating that the investor day could offer a clearing event opportunity. That said, the sustainability of the stock re-rate will ultimately depend on a successful execution, an area that is under scrutiny from investors, given the challenging operating environment.

Investment Implications

We maintain our Market-Perform and price target of \$295.

DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: McDonald's > NEXT



Source: McDonald's website

INVESTOR DAY AGENDA

- **7:45am CT:** Attendee check-in begins in Chicago
- **8:30-11:00am CT:** Webcast presentation covering McDonald's next-phase strategy across four pillars: menu, consumer, restaurant, and people. Management will also introduce longer-term financial targets and provide supporting financial detail
- **Late morning:** Formal Q&A with the senior management team, including CEO Chris Kempczinski, CFO Ian Borden, segment leaders, and functional heads
- **Lunch:** Three interactive rotations featuring food tastings and examples of how McDonald's is thinking about the evolution of its menu and core categories
- **Afternoon:** Visit to a warehouse showcasing a non-operating prototype of a new U.S. drive-thru restaurant, followed by technology demonstrations and discussion of the key enablers behind the strategy
- **Closing sessions:** A second formal Q&A at the warehouse, followed by informal reception with senior leadership. The event is expected to conclude around 4:30 pm CT

Note: Only the morning presentation, from approximately 8:30-11:00am CT, will be webcast

MENU: CAN CHICKEN AND BEVERAGES REKINDLE GROWTH?

We believe McDonald's menu strategy will revolve around two major growth platforms: **chicken** and **beverages**. Chicken is already a larger business for McDonald's than beef (both globally, and in the US), but simply adding another conventional chicken item may no longer be enough to win share. Consumers increasingly benchmark quality against chicken-focused concepts such as Chick-fil-A and Raising Cane's, where freshly prepared products offer compelling crispiness, texture, and customization. McDonald's therefore appears poised to introduce a broader hand-breaded chicken platform, potentially

spanning tenders, wings, wraps, sandwiches, and nuggets. We expect that the chicken platform will create an opportunity for McDonald's to innovate also through sauces that can amplify the impact of collaborations and enable McDonald's to capture higher average ticket as a result. Similarly, beverages provide a complementary opportunity to attract incremental visits and capture premium pricing - in line with the upside experienced in the US.

Below are the investors questions we received, that we think (and hope!) McDonald's will address at the investor day, along with our hypotheses on what McDonald's may share.

WHEN WILL THE NEW CHICKEN PLATFORM LAUNCH?

We expect that the rollout will be phased in different regions starting in **late 2027, with a possible shift into early 2028** depending on equipment availability, supply-chain readiness, and restaurant retrofits. In fact, the preparation of the chicken will require an operator to handle raw chicken, which could compromise food safety in the restaurant. To mitigate the risk, stores will need to be retrofitted to allow for a 'ringfenced' space where a dedicated employee prepares the chicken and uses specialized equipment.

CAN MCDONALD'S EXECUTE HAND-BREADED CHICKEN WITHOUT DISRUPTING OPERATIONS?

We are approaching the opportunity with a watchful eye. Burger King previously attempted hand-breaded chicken, but the added labor, food-safety requirements, and specialized equipment ultimately created meaningful operating challenges and the volumes were not sufficient to justify the investment for franchisees. Specifically, the Ch'King launched nationwide on **June 3, 2021**, used a hand-breaded whole chicken breast fillet and was offered in original, spicy, and Deluxe variants. The Ch'King was short-lived and discontinued after roughly 15 months on the national menu, with the former CEO (Jose Cil) stating that it created "a ton of bottlenecks operationally". We believe similar challenges could arise for McDonald's as the product is inherently more complex than McDonald's traditional menu items: chicken arrives raw, must be breaded in the restaurant, and may require additional employees during peak periods. It could also pressure drive-thru throughput, an important risk for a brand with 95% of locations in the US featuring drive-thrus and whose value proposition remains closely tied to convenience and speed.

The company is evaluating batch preparation and holding procedures to limit wait times, while restaurants are being retrofitted with dedicated equipment and space. If McDonald's can preserve product quality (and food safety) without sacrificing speed, chicken could represent a powerful sales and margin unlock. The operational barriers may also discourage broad imitation by traditional burger competitors, although success could intensify competition with chicken-focused concepts.

HOW LARGE IS THE BEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY?

Beverages may prove more material in the near term because the platform is already being introduced and requires less preparation than hand-breaded chicken. U.S. beverages have reportedly generated an LSD sales benefit, while our conversations with franchisees suggest that a trial across approximately ten U.K. restaurants produced a roughly 7% to 8% total-sales uplift and exhausted four weeks of planned product supply after only three weeks. Based on the early results, **we believe a broader rollout could support an MSD uplift**, although performance will vary considerably by market. The international opportunity may be particularly compelling because specialized and energy-based beverages face less competition in those markets.

Since McDonald's has already tested and / or launched the new specialty-beverage platform in Germany (April 2026), Canada (May 2026), Australia and US (July 2026), we believe the go-to-market will be more rapid compared to the new chicken platform - especially as the results have been encouraging: in the U.S., management specifically cited sales ahead of plan, higher guest checks, incremental occasions across the day, and strong food attachment.

CAN MCDONALD'S EXECUTE THE SPECIALTY-BEVERAGE PLATFORM WITHOUT DISRUPTING OPERATIONS?

We appreciate investors' concerns that speed of service may be impacted by the launch of the platform, as McDonald's reported slower service levels in 2Q26 and this coincided, incidentally only, with the rollout of the specialty beverage in the US. That said, we believe the execution of beverages is significantly simpler than that of the hand-breaded chicken platform, and we could see more QSR competitors potentially entering in the space given the results obtained by McDonald's and the minimal investment required. Operationally, restaurants will require additional capacity, including new ice machines and beverage equipment. The goal appears to be designing a scalable beverage station capable of handling higher volumes without creating another service bottleneck. We do not expect, but we would welcome, an announcement of a digital freestyle fountain dispenser that pre-mixes the sodas with the energy drink: this would significantly de-bottleneck the operations and enhance consistency, but we are worried that this endeavor may never see the light of day due to the reticence of the energy drink partners who want to protect

their own brand and positioning (e.g., display the can).

These menu ambitions lead directly into the restaurant strategy: realizing the full upside from chicken and beverages will require kitchen retrofits, new equipment, better technology, and redesigned operating processes. Remodels may provide an incremental traffic lift as newer restaurants attract customers, but the new format remains comparatively unproven, making the interaction between menu innovation and restaurant execution one of the most important Investor Day debates.

VALUE AND CONSUMER ENGAGEMENT: REBUILDING THE VALUE EQUATION

We expect the segment on “consumers” to focus on how McDonald’s is planning to restoring its value leadership through a revamped Every Day Low Price strategy in the US, while deepening engagement across marketing, loyalty, and digital channels.

On value, the challenge is particularly acute among lower-income consumers, who are visiting less frequently and spending less when they do visit, as cumulative menu-price increases and broader cost pressures have strained affordability. Management appears to recognize that rebuilding traffic will require more than temporary discounts: McDonald’s must deliver the right combination of accessible price points, compelling food, fast service, and a consistently strong restaurant experience.

On digital and loyalty we do not expect meaningful surprises, other than updates on KPIs demonstrating the progress on the key areas that were core to the former 4D strategy (Digital, Drive-thru, Delivery, Development). Conversely, we do expect some shifts in the marketing approach: we believe that McDonald’s will leverage social media and influencers in a more systematic way, likely launching consumer-inspired bottom-up campaigns that could meaningfully boost consumers’ engagement and look more natural. We see great benefits in this approach, should McDonald’s indeed adopt it, as we have seen greater returns from earned media compared to the old school owned media or even the more recent evolution of paid social and influencer/creator campaigns. That said, we expect McDonald’s to carefully watch and control the brand flow, as the repercussions of partnering with the wrong influencer could be material.

IS MCDONALD’S MOVING AWAY FROM ITS UNDER \$3 PLATFORM?

Not necessarily. McDonald’s and its U.S. franchisees agree that the system needs a sustainable everyday affordability platform, but they continue to debate its construction, including the products offered under the platform, appropriate price points (and regional differences), and required level of franchisee participation. A franchisee vote is expected on September 22, one day before Investor Day, which could provide an important signal regarding alignment around the next phase of the company’s U.S. value strategy.

In the meantime, McDonald’s is reallocating some marketing dollars away from McValue and the Under \$3 menu toward nationally priced Extra Value Meals, including an \$8 Big Mac meal and a \$5 Sausage McMuffin with Egg meal. These offers should be easier to advertise nationally and may provide consumers with a clearer, more complete value proposition than a collection of individually priced items.

CAN VALUE OFFERS DRIVE TRAFFIC WITHOUT FURTHER PRESSURING FRANCHISEES?

This remains the central debate. Franchisees have faced sluggish traffic, rising costs, and pressure on restaurant-level profitability, and we expect the U.S. restaurant operating cash flow expected to have already declined from the ~\$520K in 2025, and to further decline at the beginning of 2027, as franchisees have been somewhat protected so far from the rising utility costs and beef prices, due to hedging (but eventually contracts will need to true up). Aggressive discounting could support visits but further compress franchisee margins, particularly if participation and pricing are not consistent across the system.

We therefore expect management to emphasize a more balanced value equation rather than relying solely on lower prices. Faster service, cleaner restaurants, improved order accuracy, and greater convenience can all improve consumers’ perception of what they receive for the price paid. If operational improvements raise throughput and reduce friction, McDonald’s could strengthen value perceptions without funding the entire traffic recovery through discounts.

We further note that the closing of the Food at Home vs Food Away From Home inflation gap ([Exhibit 2](#)) could bode well for a natural expansion of the relative price perception for QSRs relative to eating at home - a critical decision node especially for low-income consumers, to which McDonald’s has disproportionate exposure.

CAN MCDONALD'S ENSURE CONSISTENT FRANCHISEE EXECUTION?

We believe that the company has more leverage than it did previously. At the beginning of 2026, McDonald's updated its franchisee standards to place greater emphasis on whether restaurants deliver appropriate value within their local trading areas. Persistent noncompliance could affect a franchisee's ability to renew agreements, acquire restaurants, or open additional locations, although management has characterized these enforcement tools as a last resort.

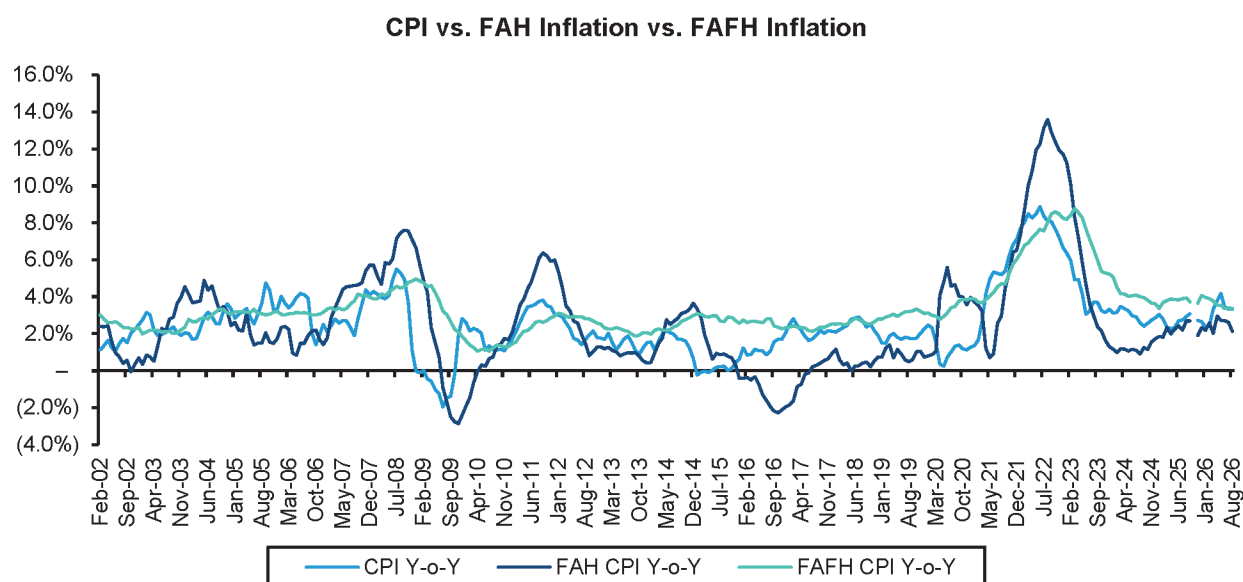
This added leverage should improve consistency, but we believe that contractual enforcement alone cannot solve the underlying economic tension, and in fact it could exacerbate it over time, with franchisees choosing to leave the system. The value platform still needs to generate enough incremental traffic to compensate franchisees for lower check averages or weaker margins.

WHAT ROLE WILL DIGITAL ENGAGEMENT PLAY?

Digital offers provide a more targeted way to drive frequency, personalize promotions, and reach value-oriented customers without lowering prices across the entire menu. However, U.S. digital offers are managed across approximately 52 regional cooperatives, creating variation in timing, discounts, and execution.

Investor Day could outline how McDonald's plans to connect national value messaging with more personalized digital engagement. The upside is meaningful: a clearer national platform can rebuild broad value credentials, while loyalty and digital offers can encourage incremental visits among specific customer groups. Ultimately, the winning formula will be one that restores traffic while protecting franchisee economics, setting the stage for the restaurant and technology investments needed to deliver faster, more consistent execution.

EXHIBIT 2: Narrowing food-at-home and food-away-from-home inflation gap should support QSR value perceptions



October 2025 data is not available due to Federal Government shutdown.
Source: FRED, Bureau of Labor Statistics, Bernstein analysis

RESTAURANTS: BUILDING THE PLATFORM FOR MCDONALD'S NEXT

Following our conversations with management and the insights we gathered through the June Worldwide Convention in Las Vegas, we expect restaurants remodels to be one of the most tangible components of McDonald's Investor Day. We expect management to introduce a new global design direction that brings more vivid colors back into restaurants, creates a more family-oriented environment, and provides the physical infrastructure needed to support future menu, digital, and operating initiatives. While the remodel program will be global, the prototype displayed at Investor Day will specifically represent a new

U.S. drive-thru restaurant.

WHAT WILL THE RESTAURANT OF THE FUTURE LOOK LIKE?

We expect the new format to serve a functional purpose beyond refreshed décor. Kitchens will require incremental space and equipment to support the chicken and beverage platforms discussed in the Menu section of this note, including dedicated chicken-preparation areas, additional ice machines, and expanded beverage capacity. The restaurant flow should also accommodate greater digital interaction, evolving fulfillment channels, smoother delivery operations, and technology designed to identify operational bottlenecks and improve throughput.

Management also appears intent on putting families back at the center of the brand. The new design is expected to feature brighter colors, stronger Happy Meal integration, screens and attractions for children, and potentially greater emphasis on play areas ([Exhibit 3](#)). Investor Day attendees will tour a non-operating U.S. drive-thru prototype that should provide greater clarity on the layout, technology, and labor model.

WHAT WILL THE REMODEL CYCLE ENTAIL AND HOW MUCH WILL IT COST?

The remodel program is expected to be a global endeavor, with markets generally working toward a consistent design while retaining flexibility for local requirements. International operated markets have remained relatively close to a 10-year remodel cadence, while approximately 70% of U.S. restaurants were last updated between 2017 and 2020, positioning a substantial portion of the domestic system to enter its next remodel window over the coming years. We believe that a comprehensive remodel could cost approximately \$500K to \$1M per restaurant, while equipment retrofits supporting chicken and beverages could require an additional \$90K to \$120K.

HOW MUCH WILL MCDONALD'S CONTRIBUTE?

Management has indicated that support could include direct capital contributions, rent relief, or a combination of both, with the structure varying by market and franchisee. For context, during the prior remodeling cycle known as Experience of the Future program (EOTF), McDonald's funded approximately 55% of the remodel.

This time though, we expect the co-investment to be more limited (in the 20% range), as most stores are due for contractual renovation anyway, and the state of the stores is relatively good, implying that McDonald's does not need to force (or better, incentivize) the remodels to take place at the same speed and with the same urgency as in the previous cycle.

If we assume a **20% contribution**, a **\$750K** remodel cost, **13,128 participating restaurants**, and implementation over five years, the implied annual corporate investment would be ~\$400M ($(20\% \times \$750K \times 13,128) \div 5$). Ahead of Investor Day, investors have shared concerns on the "significant CAPEX cycle ahead", but we believe that the ultimate burden could be more contained given the likely mix of direct capital, rent relief, normal-cycle remodeling, and targeted franchisee assistance - thus creating a clearing event opportunity for the stock

WHAT SALES UPLIFT COULD REMODELED RESTAURANTS GENERATE?

The uplift is difficult to isolate because physical remodels, menu innovation, and operating improvements will likely be implemented together. Historical remodel programs and comparable industry initiatives suggest a LDD% sales uplift in the first-year (and LSD% outperformance in outer years), but McDonald's existing restaurants are generally in better condition than Burger King's estate was ahead of its remodel program. We therefore believe an HSD uplift inclusive of menu innovation represents a more measured assumption, with the physical refresh alone likely generating a smaller benefit.

The prior U.S. cycle remodeled approximately 70% of restaurants between 2017 and 2020, but management has not yet confirmed that the upcoming cycle will be similarly compressed. Investor Day should clarify the participation rate, rollout period, corporate contribution, and expected return, all of which will determine whether Restaurant NEXT becomes a meaningful growth catalyst or primarily a necessary investment in the system's competitiveness.

EXHIBIT 3: **McDonald's prototype**

Source: Restaurant Business

PEOPLE: BUILDING THE ORGANIZATION BEHIND THE STRATEGY

The People pillar may be less tangible than menu innovation or restaurant remodels, but it will be critical to turning McDonald's ambitions into consistent execution across a global, predominantly franchised system. We expect management to focus on employee experience, restaurant execution, organizational capabilities, leadership accountability, and franchisee alignment. The central message will likely be that new products, technologies, and restaurant formats cannot deliver their full potential without well-trained restaurant teams and a corporate organization equipped to implement the strategy at scale. Importantly, we believe that McDonald's will announce more elevated operational efficiency as a result of the Global Business Service and enhanced AI capabilities. Targeting a lower G&A (for instance 2% of systemwide sales vs today's 2.2%) may increase the EPS visibility for investors, and render it attainable also under adverse macro-economic conditions - as cost controls are easier to execute and less subject to external factors, like consumers' sentiment and disposable income.

WHAT SHOULD INVESTORS EXPECT FROM THE PEOPLE PILLAR?

We expect management to explain how McDonald's plans to attract, train, and retain restaurant employees while improving execution at the store level. We also expect a showcasing of how operations will be streamlined, an area that becomes particularly important as the company introduces more complex platforms, including hand-breaded chicken, expanded beverages, new drive-thru technology, and redesigned restaurant workflows. The chicken platform, for example, could require dedicated employees during peak periods, extensive food-safety training, and new procedures for preparation, holding, and waste management.

Technology should support, rather than replace, this people strategy. Proposed tools could help managers identify bottlenecks during a shift, improve labor deployment, and determine whether delays are originating from fries, beverages, or another operating station. If successful, these capabilities could reduce pressure on restaurant teams, improve throughput, and produce a more consistent customer experience.

CAN BETTER PEOPLE PRACTICES IMPROVE RESTAURANT ECONOMICS, REALLY?

Yes. YES. We believe improved staffing, training, and shift management can translate into tangible financial benefits. Lower turnover reduces recruiting and training expenses, while better labor deployment can improve productivity without compromising service. Faster throughput, stronger order accuracy, and better hospitality can also reinforce consumers' perception of value, particularly when menu prices remain elevated.

However, investors should distinguish between productivity and simple cost reduction. The strategy may initially require incremental training, implementation resources, and restaurant labor, particularly as new menu platforms are deployed. The opportunity is for these upfront investments to generate greater capacity, stronger traffic, and more efficient operations over time, rather than producing an immediate reduction in restaurant-level costs.

WILL THE STRATEGY CREATE INCREMENTAL G&A PRESSURE?

The breadth of the strategy could create near-term spending requirements across technology development, menu testing, training, field support, marketing capabilities, and remodel execution. The addition of organizational resources focused on strategy execution also suggests that management is investing in the capabilities required to coordinate the next phase of growth.

That said, we expect that McDonald's will be able to operate under a more streamlined cost structure, as a result of the investments made with the Global Business Services and with the support of AI. The strongest outcome for the investor day in our view would be a framework in which near-term capability investments are absorbed over time through sales growth, while improved productivity and greater efficiency allow G&A to be at 2% of Systemwide Sales vs today's 2.2%.

HOW IMPORTANT IS FRANCHISEE ALIGNMENT?

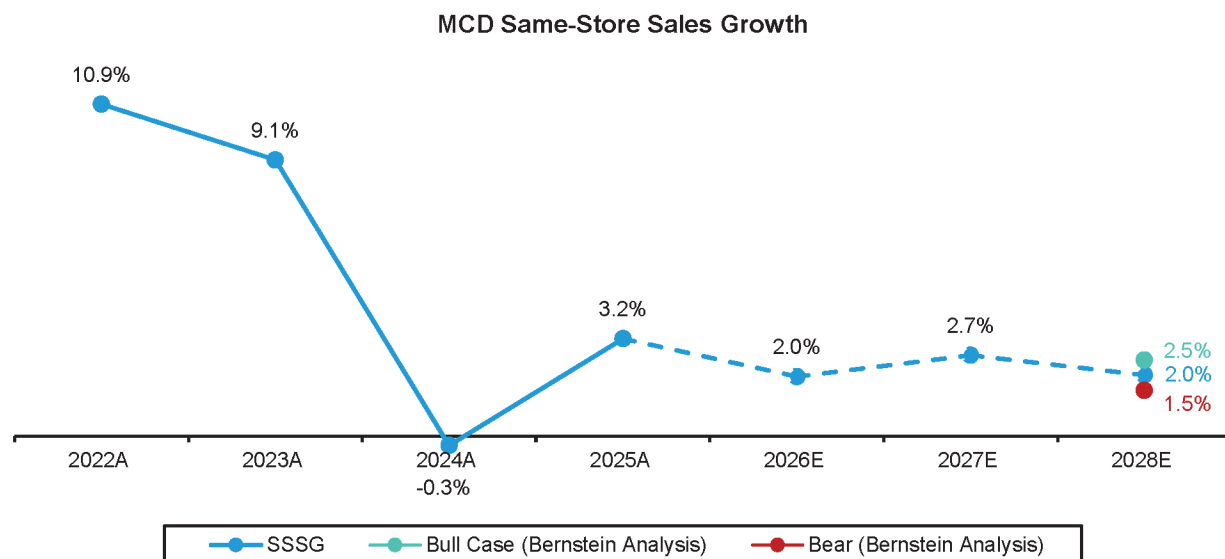
Franchisee alignment may ultimately determine the strategy's pace and consistency. Franchisees will be asked to support remodels, purchase equipment, train teams, adopt new operating processes, and participate in value programs while restaurant cash flow is already under pressure. Management is expected to discuss both the incentives that may support adoption, including capital contributions and rent relief, and the accountability mechanisms available when franchisees fail to meet system standards.

In our view, People is the connective tissue across the entire Investor Day strategy. If McDonald's can align corporate leadership, franchisees, restaurant managers, and crew around a more complex operating model, investments in menu, technology, and remodels could translate into faster growth and stronger unit economics. If execution or alignment falters, however, complexity and G&A could rise before the anticipated benefits materialize.

NEW LONG-TERM TARGETS

SSSG: LSD %

We believe that SSSG could be more sustainably reaching 2%+, with a combination of remodels, menu innovation, and digital & marketing strategies that could ignite the anemic growth witnessed in the past 3 years, even if the underlying macro-economic conditions were to worsen (our base case). For context, MCD delivered -0.3% SSSG in FY24, 3.2% in FY25 and will likely deliver 2.0% SSSG in FY26 (per consensus), with the US being the most under pressure.

EXHIBIT 4: **We expect MCD to sustain LSD same-store sales growth over the long term**

2026E and 2027E numbers represent Bloomberg consensus figures. 2028E represents Bernstein analysis, with Bull, Base, and Bear cases
Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

NEW RESTAURANT UNIT EXPANSION: 2% FROM 2.5% TARGET TODAY (OF SYSTEMWIDE SALES GROWTH)

We believe management will announce a slight reduction of contribution from new stores as we expect lower unit growth from IOM where the AUV are higher compared to the more resilient IDL markets, creating a negative mix from units. The lower contribution is also partially driven by the increased focus on remodel (hence higher return on existing units) rather than opening new units.

NET NEW RESTAURANT GROWTH: 3-4% ANNUALLY

We expect net new restaurant growth to moderate to 3% to 4% annually, versus the prior target of over 4%, reflecting higher development costs and a more pressured consumer environment that has prompted McDonald's to move its 50,000-restaurant target from 2027 to 2028. Management remains committed to accelerated development, but the revised range assumes a more disciplined pace focused on attractive restaurant-level returns, quality locations, and franchisee economics.

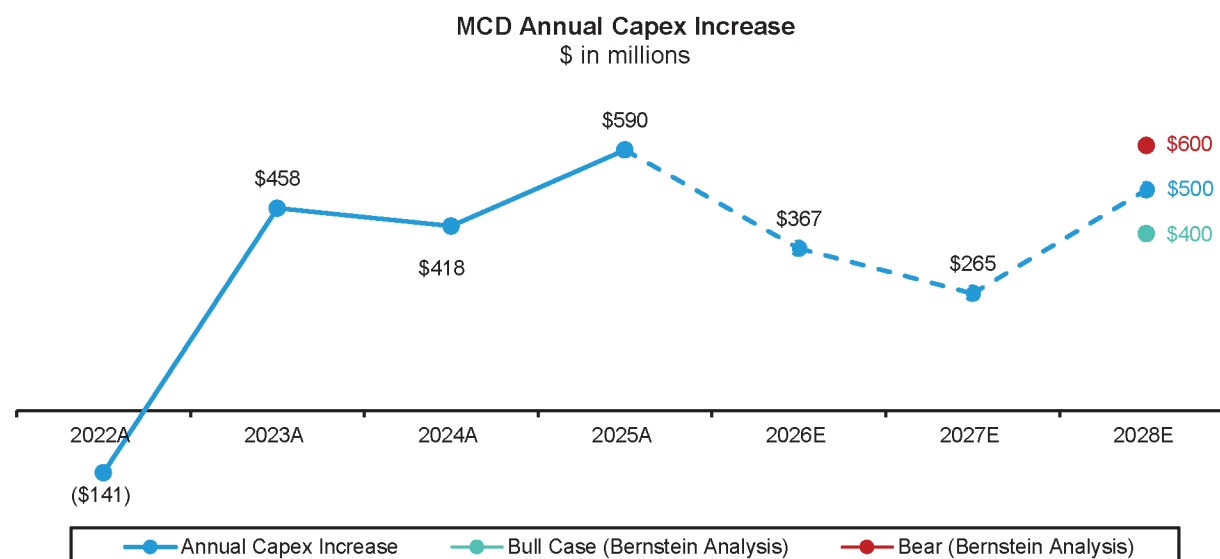
G&A: <2% OF SYSTEM WIDE SALES

We believe G&A could decline to less than 2% of systemwide sales over the long term, as McDonald's realizes efficiencies from its Global Business Services platform, consolidated global systems and processes, and greater use of AI-enabled automation. We expect benefits from these investments to begin emerging in 2027, while a more streamlined organizational structure should improve the company's ability to execute McDonald's Next at scale. Continued systemwide sales growth and incremental refranchising should provide further leverage against a more efficient corporate cost base.

CAPEX: ANNUAL SEQUENTIAL INCREASES OF \$400M - \$600M

We expect annual sequential capex increases of \$400M - \$600M, up from the prior \$300M-\$500M framework. Our estimate assumes McDonald's contributes 20% of a \$750K remodel across its 13,128 U.S. franchised restaurants, implying ~\$2B of corporate spending. We expect this investment to be deployed over four to five years, alongside continued spending on new restaurant development, company-operated remodels, technology, equipment, and digital infrastructure. However, the ultimate capex impact remains uncertain, as McDonald's could provide some franchisee support through rent relief rather than direct capital contributions; we expect Investor Day to provide greater clarity on the mix, timing, and accounting treatment of this investment.

EXHIBIT 5: We expect annual capex increases to accelerate as McDonald's enters its next remodel cycle



2026E and 2027E numbers represent Bloomberg consensus figures. 2028E represents Bernstein analysis, with Bull, Base, and Bear cases
Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

FREE CASH FLOW CONVERSION: ~75%

We expect free cash flow conversion to decline to approximately 75% over the long term, versus the 90% target outlined in 2023, reflecting the elevated capital requirements associated with restaurant development, remodels, technology, equipment, and digital infrastructure. This would represent a further moderation from 84% in 2025, 81% in 2024, and the low-to-mid 80% range expected for FY2026. While operating growth and productivity should offset some of the pressure, we believe the sustained capex step-up will limit the amount of net income converted into free cash flow during the investment cycle.

Putting it all together, we expect McDonald's to introduce a long-term framework built around 2% SSSG, a 2% contribution from net restaurant expansion, operating margins approaching or exceeding 50%, and annual sequential capex increases of \$400M - \$600M. Under our base case, these assumptions translate into 2028E diluted EPS of ~\$15; applying an 18x to 19x forward P/E multiple yields a \$270 - \$290 price target, representing 10-15% upside. In our bull case, stronger sales and margin execution could support ~\$16 of EPS and a 19x to 20x multiple, implying a \$305 - \$320 price target and ~25% upside, while operational challenges, including complexity from the chicken launch, could constrain same-store sales growth and drive ~\$14 of EPS, a 15x to 16x multiple, and ~(10%) downside in our bear case ([Exhibit 7](#)). **With investor sentiment subdued ahead of the event, Investor Day could provide a compelling catalyst and clearing event for the stock, but the durability of any re-rating will ultimately depend on McDonald's' ability to execute the strategy consistently across its global system.**

EXHIBIT 6: **McDonald's Next could reset the company's long-term financial framework...**

Metric	2023	2026
	Investor Day LT Targets	Investor Day Bernstein LT Tgts
Net Restaurant Unit Expansion (% of Systemwide Sales Growth)	2.5%	2.0%
Operating Margin	Expansion	Expansion
Capital Expenditures (Sequential Increases)	\$300M - \$500M	\$400M - \$600M
Net New Restaurant Growth	4% - 5%	3% - 4%
Free Cash Flow Conversion	~90%	~75%
Franchise Mix	N/A	97%
G&A Expense (% of Systemwide Sales)	N/A	<2%

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 7: **...with successful execution unlocking meaningful earnings growth and valuation upside**

Metric	2026 Investor Day Bernstein LT Projections		
	Bear	Base	Bull
Same-Store Sales Growth	1.5%	2.0%	2.5%
Δ vs Consensus Average from 2025 - 2028 (2.6%)	-1.1%	-0.6%	-0.1%
Net Restaurant Unit Expansion (% of Systemwide Sales Growth)	1.5%	2.0%	2.5%
Revenue Growth	3.0%	4.0%	5.0%
Δ vs Consensus Average from 2025 - 2028 (4.6%)	-1.6%	-0.6%	0.5%
G&A Expense (% of Systemwide Sales)	2.2%	2.0%	1.8%
Capital Expenditures (Sequential Increases)	\$500M - \$700M	\$400M - \$600M	\$300M - \$500M
2028E Operating Margin	49.1%	50.2%	51.3%
2028E Adjusting Operating Margin	50.3%	51.4%	52.6%
2028E Diluted EPS	\$14.3	\$15.2	\$16.1
% vs Consensus (\$14.88)	-3.7%	2.0%	7.9%
Forward P/E Multiple	15x - 16x	18x - 19x	19x - 20x
Δ vs Consensus (16.6x)	-1.1x	+1.9x	+2.9x
Implied Target Price	\$222	\$281	\$313
% Upside / Downside	-10.6%	13.0%	25.9%

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 8: Income statement

Fiscal year Quarter end date	FY2019 31-Dec-19	FY2020 31-Dec-20	FY2021 31-Dec-21	FY2022 31-Dec-22	FY2023 31-Dec-23	FY2024 31-Dec-24	FY2025 31-Dec-25	FY2026E 31-Dec-26	FY2027E 31-Dec-27	FY2028E 31-Dec-28	FY2029E 31-Dec-29
INCOME STATEMENT											
Sales by company operated restaurants	9,421	8,139	9,787	8,748	9,742	9,782	9,690	9,811	9,976	10,272	10,579
Revenues from franchised restaurants	11,656	10,726	13,085	14,106	15,437	15,715	16,548	17,212	18,101	19,080	20,110
Other revenues	288	343	350	328	316	423	647	735	764	798	835
Total Revenues	21,364	19,208	23,223	23,183	25,494	25,920	26,885	27,758	28,841	30,151	31,523
Company-operated restaurant expenses	7,761	6,951	8,047	7,381	8,224	8,334	8,269	8,362	8,482	8,718	8,962
Franchised restaurants-occupancy expenses	2,201	2,208	2,335	2,350	2,475	2,536	2,618	2,710	2,849	3,000	3,158
Other restaurant expenses	224	267	260	245	233	339	564	650	676	707	739
SG&A	2,229	2,546	2,708	2,863	2,817	2,858	3,039	3,144	3,230	3,317	3,405
Other operating (income) expenses	(120)	(118)	(483)	974	99	139	2	(33)	(248)	(248)	(248)
Total operating costs and expenses	12,295	11,884	12,867	13,812	13,847	14,206	14,492	14,832	14,989	15,493	16,016
EBIT (Operating income)	9,070	7,324	10,356	9,371	11,647	11,714	12,393	12,926	13,852	14,658	15,508
Interest expense (income), net	1,122	1,218	1,186	1,207	1,361	1,506	1,582	1,660	1,740	1,824	1,916
Non-operating (income) expense, net	(70)	(35)	42	339	(236)	(139)	(87)	5	(1)	(3)	(3)
Other expenses	-	0	(0)	-	-	(1)	-	-	-	-	-
Income before provision for taxes	8,018	6,141	9,128	7,825	10,522	10,348	10,898	11,260	12,113	12,836	13,594
Income tax expense (benefit)	1,993	1,410	1,583	1,648	2,053	2,122	2,334	2,462	2,716	2,843	3,029
Net income from Continuing Operations	6,025	4,731	7,545	6,177	8,469	8,226	8,564	8,798	9,397	9,993	10,565
Non-continuing Ops adjustments	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Net income	6,025	4,731	7,545	6,177	8,469	8,226	8,564	8,798	9,397	9,993	10,565

EPS and Share repurchases											
Weighted Avg. Basic Shares Outstanding (M of units)	758	745	746	737	728	718	713	708	703	698	694
Weighted Avg. Diluted Shares Outstanding (M of units)	765	750	752	741	732	722	716	711	706	701	697
Basic EPS reported	\$ 7.95	\$ 6.35	\$ 10.11	\$ 8.39	\$ 11.56	\$ 11.39	\$ 12.00	\$ 12.43	\$ 13.37	\$ 14.32	\$ 15.23
Basic EPS Cont. Ops	\$ 7.95	\$ 6.35	\$ 10.11	\$ 8.39	\$ 11.56	\$ 11.39	\$ 11.98	\$ 12.43	\$ 13.37	\$ 14.32	\$ 15.23
Diluted EPS reported (GAAP)	\$ 7.88	\$ 6.31	\$ 10.04	\$ 8.33	\$ 11.56	\$ 11.39	\$ 11.95	\$ 12.38	\$ 13.31	\$ 14.25	\$ 15.16
Diluted EPS Cont. Ops (Non-GAAP)	\$ 7.84	\$ 6.05	\$ 9.28	\$ 10.10	\$ 11.94	\$ 11.72	\$ 12.20	\$ 12.53	\$ 13.55	\$ 14.46	\$ 15.37
Dividends per share	\$ 4.73	\$ 5.04	\$ 6.63	\$ 5.66	\$ 6.23	\$ 6.78	\$ 7.17	\$ 7.53	\$ 7.91	\$ 8.31	\$ 8.72

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 9: Balance sheet

Fiscal year Quarter end date	FY2019 31-Dec-19	FY2020 31-Dec-20	FY2021 31-Dec-21	FY2022 31-Dec-22	FY2023 31-Dec-23	FY2024 31-Dec-24	FY2025 31-Dec-25	FY2026E 31-Dec-26	FY2027E 31-Dec-27	FY2028E 31-Dec-28	FY2029E 31-Dec-29
BALANCE SHEET											
Cash and Equivalents	899	3,449	4,709	2,584	4,579	1,085	774	3,629	6,071	8,359	10,638
Accounts and notes receivable	2,224	2,110	1,872	2,115	2,488	2,383	2,466	2,499	2,579	2,718	2,865
Inventories	50	51	56	52	53	56	61	57	58	59	61
Prepaid Expenses and other assets	385	633	511	673	866	1,074	862	1,058	1,099	1,149	1,201
Other assets	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total Current Assets	3,558	6,243	7,149	5,424	7,986	4,598	4,163	7,243	9,807	12,286	14,765
PPE, Gross	39,051	41,477	41,917	41,038	43,570	44,177	49,290	52,557	56,467	60,555	64,828
Accumulated D&A	(14,891)	(16,518)	(17,196)	(17,264)	(18,662)	(18,882)	(21,049)	(23,176)	(25,795)	(28,530)	(31,386)
PPE, Net	24,160	24,958	24,721	23,774	24,908	25,295	28,241	29,381	30,672	32,024	33,442
Investments in and advances to affiliates	1,270	1,297	1,201	1,065	1,080	2,710	2,820	2,865	2,865	2,865	2,865
Goodwill	2,677	2,773	2,783	2,900	3,040	3,145	3,354	3,349	3,349	3,349	3,349
Lease right-of-use assets, net	13,261	13,828	13,552	12,566	13,514	13,339	14,606	14,513	14,513	14,513	14,513
Other LT assets	2,584	3,527	4,450	4,707	5,618	6,095	6,331	6,357	6,357	6,357	6,357
Total LT Assets	43,953	46,384	46,706	45,011	48,160	50,584	55,352	56,465	57,756	59,108	60,526
Total Assets	47,511	52,627	53,854	50,436	56,147	55,182	59,515	63,707	67,563	71,394	75,291
Accounts payable	988	741	1,007	980	1,103	1,029	1,149	1,028	1,043	1,072	1,102
Lease liability	621	702	706	661	688	636	694	707	707	707	707
Accrued interest	338	388	363	393	469	482	533	463	486	509	535
Accrued payroll and other liabilities	1,036	1,138	1,347	1,237	1,434	1,129	1,488	1,271	1,321	1,381	1,444
Current maturities of LT debt	59	2,244	-	-	-	-	-	630	667	704	744
Other current liabilities	579	968	597	530	3,166	585	497	643	643	643	643
Total Current Liabilities	3,621	6,181	4,020	3,802	6,859	3,861	4,361	4,742	4,866	5,016	5,174
Long-term debt	34,118	35,197	35,623	35,904	37,153	38,424	39,973	41,980	44,473	46,959	49,581
Long-term lease liabilities	12,758	13,321	13,021	12,134	13,058	12,888	14,147	14,069	14,069	14,069	14,069
Deferred income taxes	1,318	2,026	2,076	1,998	1,681	1,914	1,038	1,220	1,220	1,220	1,220
Other long-term liabilities	3,906	3,727	3,716	2,602	2,103	1,892	1,788	1,783	1,783	1,783	1,783
Total LT Liabilities	52,100	54,271	54,435	52,637	53,995	55,118	56,946	59,052	61,545	64,031	66,653
Total Liabilities	55,721	60,452	58,455	56,439	60,854	58,979	61,307	63,795	66,412	69,047	71,827
Common Stock	17	17	17	17	17	17	17	17	17	17	17
Additional Paid In Capital	7,654	7,904	8,232	8,547	8,893	9,281	9,641	9,792	9,792	9,792	9,792
Treasury Stock	(66,329)	(67,066)	(67,810)	(71,624)	(74,640)	(77,375)	(79,318)	(81,279)	(83,879)	(86,879)	(90,279)
Retained Earnings	52,931	53,908	57,535	59,544	63,480	66,834	70,282	73,746	77,585	81,781	86,298
Accumulated Other Comprehensive Income (Loss)	(2,483)	(2,587)	(2,574)	(2,487)	(2,456)	(2,554)	(2,414)	(2,363)	(2,363)	(2,363)	(2,363)
Total Shareholders' Equity	(8,210)	(7,825)	(4,601)	(6,003)	(4,707)	(3,797)	(1,792)	(87)	1,151	2,347	3,465
Total Liabilities and Shareholders' Equity	47,511	52,627	53,854	50,436	56,147	55,182	59,515	63,707	67,563	71,394	75,291

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates



更多最新 纪要 录音
内资研报 外资研报
财联社 红B书 先知

EXHIBIT 10: Cash flow statement

Fiscal year	FY2019	FY2020	FY2021	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026E	FY2027E	FY2028E	FY2029E
Quarter end date	31-Dec-19	31-Dec-20	31-Dec-21	31-Dec-22	31-Dec-23	31-Dec-24	31-Dec-25	31-Dec-26	31-Dec-27	31-Dec-28	31-Dec-29
CASHFLOW											
Net income	6,025	4,731	7,545	6,177	8,469	8,226	8,564	8,796	9,397	9,993	10,565
Depreciation and amortization	1,618	1,751	1,868	1,871	1,978	2,097	2,199	2,510	2,619	2,735	2,856
Deferred income taxes	150	6	(428)	(346)	(686)	(574)	(50)	63	-	-	-
Share-based compensation	110	92	139	167	175	172	165	60	-	-	-
Change in working capital items	299	(212)	454	(645)	(108)	(438)	(1,860)	(108)	(35)	(79)	(82)
Accounts receivable	27	(7)	310	(264)	(161)	10	113	(67)	(80)	(139)	(147)
Inventories, prepaid expenses and other current assets	129	(69)	(62)	6	17	71	164	(8)	(42)	(52)	(54)
Accounts payable	(27)	(138)	225	31	50	(10)	177	(63)	15	29	30
Income taxes	173	(44)	(303)	(547)	(220)	(292)	-	-	-	-	-
Other accrued liabilities	(4)	44	284	129	206	(217)	17	29	72	83	89
Other, net	(79)	(103)	(437)	162	(216)	(37)	(2,577)	(261)	-	-	-
Cash from operations	8,122	6,265	9,142	7,387	9,612	9,446	10,551	11,060	11,981	12,649	13,339
CAPEX	(2,394)	(1,641)	(2,040)	(1,899)	(2,357)	(2,775)	(3,365)	(3,762)	(3,910)	(4,087)	(4,273)
Purchase of restaurant business	-	(66)	(374)	(807)	(441)	(669)	(240)	(79)	-	-	-
Sales of restaurant business	(49)	104	302	485	290	433	185	72	-	-	-
Sales of property	-	-	-	-	-	-	38	34	-	-	-
Other, net	(629)	57	(54)	(457)	(676)	(2,335)	(497)	(122)	-	-	-
Cash from investing	(3,071)	(1,546)	(2,166)	(2,678)	(3,185)	(5,346)	(3,879)	(3,857)	(3,910)	(4,087)	(4,273)
Net short term borrowing	-	(893)	15	26	213	326	(794)	(161)	37	37	39
Long-term financing issuance	3,236	5,543	1,154	3,375	5,221	2,380	5,224	4,553	2,493	2,486	2,622
Long-term financing repayments	-	(2,412)	(2,240)	(2,202)	(2,441)	(2,777)	(2,644)	(1,520)	-	-	-
Treasury stock purchases	(4,976)	(908)	(846)	(3,896)	(3,054)	(2,824)	(2,043)	(2,002)	(2,600)	(3,000)	(3,400)
Dividends	(3,582)	(3,753)	(3,919)	(4,168)	(4,533)	(4,870)	(5,120)	(5,331)	(5,559)	(5,797)	(6,047)
Proceeds from stock option exercises	327	296	286	248	260	328	217	128	-	-	-
Other, net	-	(122)	(47)	38	(40)	(56)	6	(1)	-	-	-
Cash from financing	(4,995)	(2,249)	(5,596)	(6,580)	(4,374)	(7,493)	(5,154)	(4,334)	(5,628)	(6,274)	(6,787)
Net change in cash	56	2,470	1,380	(1,872)	2,053	(3,393)	1,518	2,869	2,443	2,288	2,279
Effect of exchange rate changes	(24)	60	(120)	(254)	(56)	(101)	110	(14)	-	-	-
Cash & equivalents at beginning of period	866	899	3,449	4,709	2,584	4,579	1,085	2,713	5,568	8,010	10,298
Total Cash, restricted cash & equivalents at end of period	899	3,449	4,709	2,584	4,579	1,085	2,713	5,568	8,010	10,298	12,577
Cash balance of businesses held for sale at end of year	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Change in cash of business held for sale	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Cash & equivalents at end of period	899	3,449	4,709	2,584	4,579	1,085	2,713	5,568	8,010	10,298	12,577

Pending company disclosures

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis and estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	17 Sep	Price	TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			2026		Rel.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
			Closing	Target	Perf.							
MCD (McDonald's)	M	USD	248.48	295.00	(34.2)%	USD	12.20	12.53	13.55	20.4	19.8	18.3
SPX			7,637.76									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.



更多最新 纪要 录音
 内资研报 外资研报
 财联社 红B书 先知

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

Bernstein is part of a joint venture between Société Générale (SG) and AllianceBernstein, L.P. (AB). Unless specifically noted otherwise, for purposes of these disclosures, references to Bernstein's "affiliates" relate to both SG and AB and their respective affiliates.

VALUATION METHODOLOGY**McDonald's Corp**

We maintain our Market-Perform. Our MCD price target is \$295. We value MCD on NTM PE basis at 23x multiple with NTM EPS at \$12.98.

RISKS**McDonald's Corp**

Upside risks: (1) Unexpected improvement in consumer demand and labor market, and (2) Lower than expected commodity input prices adding less pressure on restaurant margins and earnings.

Downside risks: (1) Increasing international competition, (2) De-globalization, and (3) Strengthening of the dollar against other major currencies.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp
- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 10 pp
- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Autonomous research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Autonomous brand common stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – preferred stocks

The Autonomous brand has three categories of preferred stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to outperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

AUTONOMOUS CREDIT RESEARCH

Where this report contains investment recommendations for credit instruments, as defined in article 3(1)(35) of the Market Abuse Regulation, the information below is presented to comply with its disclosure requirements.

The report may also include reference(s) to published opinions by other Autonomous or Bernstein analysts covering the equity securities of the issuer(s) referenced herein. Please note an investment recommendation for credit instruments published by the author(s) of this report may differ from the published view of the analyst covering equity securities for the issuer(s) contained in this report and vice versa.

CREDIT RATINGS DEFINITIONS

The Autonomous brand has three categories of credit ratings:

- **Credit Outperform (C-OP):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to outperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- **Credit Neutral (C-N):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to perform in line with the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- **Credit Underperform (C-UP):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous credit ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

A list of all investment recommendations produced by the author(s) of this report alongside credit ratings history are available upon request.

It is at the sole discretion of the Firm as to when to initiate, update and cease research coverage. The Firm has established, maintains and relies on information barriers to control the flow of information contained in one or more areas (i.e. the private side) within the Firm, and into other areas, units, groups or affiliates (i.e. public side) of the Firm

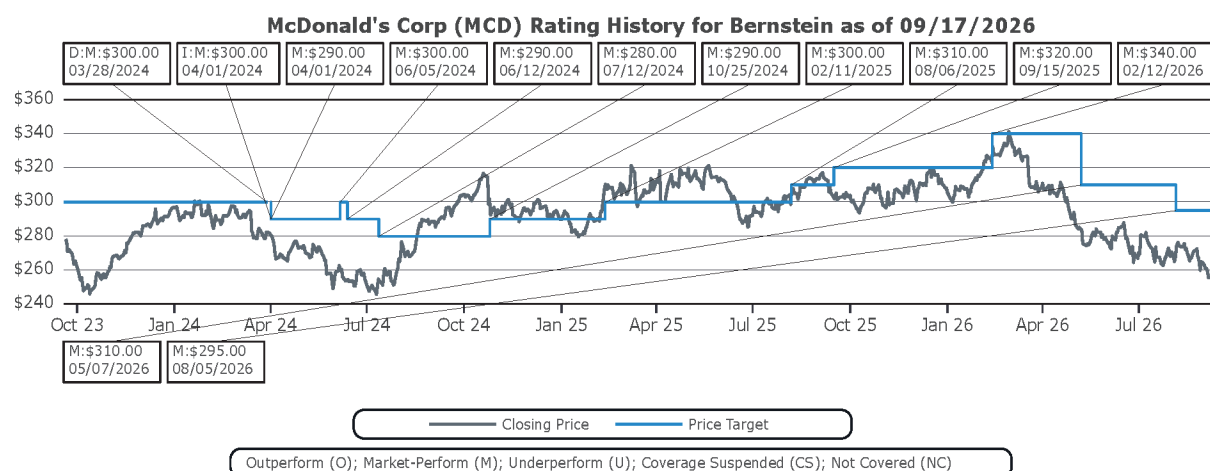
DISTRIBUTION OF EQUITY RATINGS/INVESTMENT BANKING SERVICES

Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

PRICE CHARTS / RATINGS AND PRICE TARGET HISTORY

Prior to April 1, 2024, Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC. issued the ratings and price target information in the graph(s) below for the following companies: McDonald's Corp.



All price target and closing price data in the chart(s) above are denominated in the currency noted in the Ticker Table of this report.

CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

SG and/or an affiliate is acting as Passive Bookrunner in McDonald's Corporation's bond issue (EUR 1bn, 7y and 12y). Bernstein and/or affiliates have received compensation for investment banking services in the past twelve months from McDonald's Corp.

Bernstein and/or affiliates have received compensation for non-investment banking securities-related products or services in the previous twelve months from the following clients: McDonald's Corp.

Affiliates of Bernstein managed or co-managed in the past twelve months a public offering of securities of McDonald's Corp.

Bernstein and/or affiliates had an investment banking client relationship during the past twelve months with McDonald's Corp.

Certain affiliates of Bernstein act as market maker or liquidity provider in the equities securities of: McDonald's Corp.

Certain affiliates of Bernstein act as market maker or liquidity provider in the debt securities of: McDonald's Corp.

OTHER MATTERS

The legal entity(ies) employing the analyst(s) listed in this report, and their location, can be determined by the country code of their phone number, as follows:

- +1 Bernstein Institutional Services LLC; New York, New York, USA
- +44 Bernstein Autonomous LLP; London UK
- +212 Société Générale Global Solution Center Morocco, Casablanca, Morocco
- +33 BSG France S.A.; Paris, France
- +34 BSG France S.A.; Madrid, Spain
- +41 Bernstein Autonomous LLP; Geneva, Switzerland
- +49 BSG France S.A.; Frankfurt, Germany
- +91 Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited; Mumbai, India
- +852 Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司; Hong Kong, China
- +65 Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited; Singapore
- +81 Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK; Tokyo, Japan

Where this report has been prepared by research analyst(s) employed by a non-US affiliate, such analyst(s), is/are (unless otherwise expressly noted below) not registered as associated persons of Bernstein Institutional Services LLC or any other SEC-registered broker-dealer and are not licensed or qualified as research analysts with FINRA. Accordingly, such analyst(s) may not be subject to FINRA's restrictions regarding (among other things) communications by research analysts with a subject company, interactions between research analysts and investment banking personnel, participation by research analysts in solicitation and marketing activities relating to investment banking transactions, public appearances by research analysts, and trading securities held by a research analyst account.

Where this report has been prepared by research analyst(s) employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services (part of the Société Générale group of companies), it has been prepared on behalf of a Bernstein company under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

CERTIFICATION

Each research analyst listed in this report, who is primarily responsible for the preparation of the content of this report, certifies that all of the views expressed in this publication accurately reflect that analyst's personal views about any and all of the subject

securities or issuers and that no part of that analyst's compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views in this publication.

II. ADDITIONAL GLOBAL CONFLICT DISCLOSURES

It is at the sole discretion of the Firm as to when to initiate, update and cease research coverage. The Firm has established, maintains and relies on information barriers to control the flow of information contained in one or more areas (i.e., the private side) within the Firm, and into other areas, units, groups or affiliates (i.e., public side) of the Firm.

III. OTHER IMPORTANT INFORMATION AND DISCLOSURES

Separate branding is maintained for “Bernstein” and “Autonomous” research products.

- Bernstein produces a number of different types of research products including, among others, fundamental analysis and quantitative analysis under both the “Autonomous” and “Bernstein” brands. Recommendations contained within one type of research product may differ from recommendations contained within other types of research products, whether as a result of differing time horizons, methodologies or otherwise. Furthermore, views or recommendations within a research product issued under one brand may differ from views or recommendations under the same type of research product issued under the other brand. The Research Ratings System for the two brands and other information related to those Rating Systems are included in the previous section.
- Autonomous operates as a separate business unit within the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC, Bernstein Autonomous LLP, Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司 and Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited. For information relating to “Autonomous” branded products (including certain Sales materials) please visit: www.autonomous.com. For information relating to Bernstein branded products please visit: www.bernsteinresearch.com.

Analysts are compensated based on aggregate contributions to the research franchise as measured by account penetration, productivity and proactivity of investment ideas. No analysts are compensated based on performance in, or contributions to, generating investment banking revenues.

This report has been produced by an independent analyst as defined in Article 3 (1)(34)(i) of EU 596/2014 Market Abuse Regulation (“MAR”) and the same article of MAR as it forms part of United Kingdom domestic law by virtue of the European Union (Withdrawal) Act 2018.

To our readers in the United States: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC, a broker-dealer registered with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (“SEC”) and a member of the U.S. Financial Industry Regulatory Authority, Inc. (“FINRA”) is distributing this publication in the United States and accepts responsibility for its contents. Where this material contains an analysis of debt product(s), such material is intended only for institutional investors and is not subject to the US independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research prepared for retail investors.

Bernstein Institutional Services LLC may act as principal for its own account or as agent for another person (including an affiliate) in sales or purchases of any security which is a subject of this report. This report does not purport to meet the objectives or needs of any specific individuals, entities or accounts.

To our readers in Canada: If this publication pertains to a Canadian domiciled company, it is being distributed in Canada by Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, which is licensed and regulated by the Canadian Investment Regulatory Organization. If the publication pertains to a non-Canadian domiciled company, it is being distributed by Bernstein Institutional Services LLC, which is licensed and regulated by both the SEC and FINRA, into Canada under the International Dealers Exemption.

This document may not be passed onto any person in Canada unless that person qualifies as “permitted client” as defined in Section 1.1 of NI 31-103.

To our readers in Brazil: This report has been prepared by Bernstein Institutional Services LLC, and Banco BTG Pactual S.A. (“BTG”) is responsible for the distribution of this report in Brazil.

To readers in the United Kingdom: This publication has been issued or approved for issue in the United Kingdom by Bernstein Autonomous LLP, authorised and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and located at 60 London Wall, London EC2M 5SH, +44 (0)20-7170-5000. Registered in England & Wales No OC343985.

This document is for distribution only to persons who (i) have professional experience in matters relating to investments falling within Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (as amended, the “Financial Promotion Order”), (ii) are persons falling within Article 49(2)(a) to (d) (“high net worth companies, unincorporated associations,

etc.”) of the Financial Promotion Order, (iii) are outside the United Kingdom, or (iv) are persons to whom an invitation or inducement to engage in investment activity (within the meaning of section 21 of the FSMA) in connection with the issue or sale of any securities may otherwise lawfully be communicated or caused to be communicated (all such persons together being referred to as “relevant persons”). This document is directed only at relevant persons and must not be acted on or relied on by persons who are not relevant persons. Any investment or investment activity to which this document relates is available only to relevant persons and will be engaged in only with relevant persons.

To our readers in the member states of the EEA: This publication is being distributed by BSG France SA, which is authorised and regulated by the Autorité de Contrôle Prudentiel et de Résolution (ACPR) and Autorité des Marchés Financiers (AMF).

To our readers in Hong Kong: This publication is being distributed in Hong Kong by Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, which is licensed and regulated by the Hong Kong Securities and Futures Commission (Central Entity No. AXC846) to carry out Type 4 (Advising on Securities) regulated activities and subject to the licensing conditions mentioned in the SFC Public Register (<https://www.sfc.hk/publicregWeb/corp/AXC846/details>). This publication is solely for professional investors, as defined in the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571). The purpose of this report is solely to provide an analysis of the issuers referred to in this report and is not intended for any purpose contrary to the laws of Hong Kong.

To our readers in Singapore: This publication is being distributed in Singapore by Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, only to accredited investors or institutional investors, as defined in the Securities and Futures Act 2001 of Singapore (“SFA”). Recipients in Singapore should contact Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited in respect of matters arising from, or in connection with, this publication. Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited is regulated by the Monetary Authority of Singapore and licensed under the SFA as a capital markets services licence holder for dealing in capital markets products that are securities and collective investment schemes and an exempt financial adviser for advising on, issuing and promulgating analyses and reports on securities. Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited is registered in Singapore with Company Registration No. 20213710W and located at 8 Marina Boulevard, #12-01, Marina Bay Financial Centre, Singapore 018981, +65-6326-7000.

To our readers in the People’s Republic of China: The securities referred to in this document are not being offered or sold and may not be offered or sold, directly or indirectly, in the People’s Republic of China (for such purposes, not including the Hong Kong and Macau Special Administrative Regions or Taiwan, the “PRC”) in contravention of any applicable laws of the PRC.

This document does not constitute an offer to sell or the solicitation of an offer to buy any securities in the PRC to any person to whom it is unlawful to make the offer or solicitation in the PRC.

We do not represent that this document may be lawfully distributed, or that any securities may be lawfully offered, in compliance with any applicable registration or other requirements in the PRC, or pursuant to an exemption available thereunder, or assume any responsibility for facilitating any such distribution or offering. In particular, no action has been taken by us which would permit a public offering of any securities or distribution of this document in the PRC. Accordingly, the securities are not being offered or sold within the PRC by means of this document or any other document. Neither this document nor any advertisement or other offering material may be distributed or published in the PRC, except under circumstances that will result in compliance with any applicable laws and regulations.

To our readers in Japan: This publication is being distributed in Japan by Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社), which is registered in Japan as a Financial Instruments Business Operator with the Kanto Local Finance Bureau (registration number: The Director-General of Kanto Local Finance Bureau (FIBO) No.3387) and regulated by the Financial Services Agency. It is also a member of Investment Management Association of Japan. This publication is solely for qualified institutional investors in Japan only, as defined in Article 2, paragraph (3), items (i) of the Financial Instruments and Exchange Act.

For the institutional client readers in Japan who have been granted access to the Bernstein website by Daiwa Securities Group Inc. (“Daiwa”), your access to this document should not be construed as meaning that Bernstein is providing you with investment advice for any purposes. Whilst Bernstein has prepared this document, your relationship is, and will remain with, Daiwa, and Bernstein has neither any contractual relationship with you nor any obligations towards you.

To our readers in Australia: Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司 is responsible for distributing research in Australia. It is regulated by the Securities and Exchange Commission under U.S. laws, by the Financial Conduct Authority under U.K. laws, which differs from Australian laws. Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司 is exempt from the requirement to hold an Australian financial services license under the Corporations Act 2001 in respect of the provision of the following financial services to wholesale clients:

- providing financial product advice;
- dealing in a financial product;

- making a market for a financial product; and
- providing a custodial or depository service.

To our readers in India: This publication is being distributed in India by Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SCB India) which is licensed and regulated by Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") as a research analyst entity under the SEBI (Research Analyst) Regulations, 2014, having registration no. INH000006378 and as a stock broker having registration no. INZ000213537. SCB India is currently engaged in the business of providing research and stock broking services. Please refer to www.bernsteinresearch.in for more information.

- SCB India is a Private limited company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013, on April 12, 2017 bearing corporate identification number U65999MH2017FTC293762, and registered office at Level 3A, 4th Floor, First International Financial Centre, Plot Nos C-54 and C-55, G Block, Near CBI Office, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400098, Maharashtra, India (Phone No: +91-22-68421401).
- For details of Associates (i.e., affiliates/group companies) of SCB India, kindly email MUM-BERNSTEIN-InCompliance@bernsteinsg.com.
- SCB India does not have any disciplinary history as on the date of this report.
- Except as noted above, SCB India and/or its Associates (i.e., affiliates/group companies), the Research Analysts authoring this report, and their relatives
 - do not have any financial interest in the subject company
 - do not have actual/beneficial ownership of one percent or more in securities of the subject company;
 - is not engaged in any investment banking activities for Indian companies, as such;
 - have not managed or co-managed a public offering in the past twelve months for any Indian companies;
 - have not received any compensation for investment banking services or merchant banking services from the subject company in the past 12 months;
 - have not received compensation for brokerage services from the subject company in the past twelve months;
 - have not received any compensation or other benefits from the subject company or third party related to the specific recommendations or views in this report; and
 - do not currently, but may in the future, act as a market maker in the financial instruments of the companies covered in the report.
 - do not have any conflict of interest in the subject company as of the date of this report.
- Except as noted above, the subject company has not been a client of SCB India during twelve months preceding the date of distribution of this research report. Neither SCB India nor its Associates (i.e., affiliates/group companies) have received compensation for products or services other than investment banking, merchant banking or brokerage services from the subject company in the past twelve months.
- The principal research analyst(s) who prepared this report, members of the analysts' team, and members of their households are not an officer, director, employee or advisory board member of the companies covered in the report.
- Our Compliance officer / Grievance officer is Ms. Rupal Talati, who can be reached at +91-22-68421451, or MUM-BERNSTEIN-InCompliance@bernsteinsg.com / Scbin-investorgrievance@bernsteinsg.com
- The Research investor charter and Terms & Conditions of SCB India are available on its website and may be accessed at [Sanford C. Bernstein \(India\) Private Limited](http://Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited) (<https://bernsteinresearch.in/>) for your reference.
- Disclaimer: Registration granted by SEBI, and certification from NISM, is in no way a guarantee of performance of the intermediary or provide any assurance of returns to investors. Investments in securities market are subject to market risks. Read

all the related documents carefully before investing.

To our readers in Switzerland: This document is provided in Switzerland by or through Bernstein Autonomous LLP, and is provided only to qualified investors as defined in article 10 of the Swiss Collective Investment Scheme Act ("CISA") and related provisions of the Collective Investment Scheme Ordinance and in strict compliance with applicable Swiss law and regulations. The products mentioned in this document may not be suitable for all types of investors. This document is based on the Directives on the Independence of Financial Research issued by the Swiss Bankers Association (SBA) in January 2008.

To our readers in the Middle East: Bernstein Autonomous LLP, DIFC branch has its principal office at Gate Village 06, DIFC, Dubai, UAE. Bernstein Autonomous LLP, DIFC branch is regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority (DFSA) with the registration number CL10040 and is provisioned for Arranging Deals in Investments and Advising on Financial Products. All communications and services are directed at Professional Clients and Market Counterparties only (as defined in the DFSA rulebook). Persons other than Professional Clients and Market Counterparties, such as Retail Clients, are not the intended recipients of our communications or services.

LEGAL

All research publications are disseminated to our clients through posting on the firm's password protected websites, bernsteinresearch.com and autonomous.com. Certain, but not all, research publications are also made available to clients through third-party vendors or redistributed to clients through alternate electronic means as a convenience.

This publication has been published and distributed in accordance with the Firm's policy for management of conflicts of interest in investment research, a copy of which is available from Bernstein Institutional Services LLC, Director of Compliance, 245 Park Avenue, New York, NY 10167. Additional disclosures and information regarding Bernstein's business are available on our website www.bernsteinresearch.com.

The securities described herein may not be eligible for sale in all jurisdictions or to certain categories of investors where that permission profile is not consistent with the licenses held by the entities noted herein. This document is for distribution only as may be permitted by law. This publication is not directed to, or intended for distribution to or use by, any person or entity who is a citizen or resident of, or located in any locality, state, country or other jurisdiction where such distribution, publication, availability or use would be contrary to law or regulation or which would subject any of the entities referenced herein or any of their subsidiaries or affiliates to any registration or licensing requirement within such jurisdiction. This publication is based upon public sources we believe to be reliable, but no representation is made by us that the publication is accurate or complete. We do not undertake to advise you of any change in the reported information or in the opinions herein. This publication was prepared and issued by entity referred to herein for distribution to eligible counterparties or professional clients. This publication is not an offer to buy or sell any security, and it does not constitute investment, legal or tax advice. The investments referred to herein may not be suitable for you. Investors must make their own investment decisions in consultation with their professional advisors in light of their specific circumstances. The value of investments may fluctuate, and investments that are denominated in foreign currencies may fluctuate in value as a result of exposure to exchange rate movements. Information about past performance of an investment is not necessarily a guide to, indicator of, or assurance of, future performance.

This report is directed to and intended only for our clients who are "eligible counterparties", "professional clients", "institutional investors" and/or "professional investors" as defined by the aforementioned regulators, and must not be redistributed to retail clients as defined by the aforementioned regulators. Retail clients who receive this report should note that the services of the entities noted herein are not available to them and should not rely on the material herein to make an investment decision. The result of such act will not hold the entities noted herein liable for any loss thus incurred as the entities noted herein are not registered/ authorised/ licensed to deal with retail clients and will not enter into any contractual agreement/arrangement with retail clients. This report is provided subject to the terms and conditions of any agreement that the clients may have entered into with the entities noted herein. All research reports are disseminated on a simultaneous basis to eligible clients through electronic publication to our client portal.

The information in this report was prepared by Bernstein solely for the internal business use of our clients. Clients may store, display, analyze, reformat and print the information in this report for this limited use only. Clients may not copy, alter, create derivative works, resell, reverse engineer, commercially exploit, share or distribute any part of the information contained herein for any purpose without Bernstein's express written consent. These restrictions include extracting data or using the content to develop indices or other products. Further, you may not use this report, or any portion of this report, to train or finetune any third-party machine learning or artificial intelligence system, or as a prompt or input into any such system. You also may not, without Bernstein's express written consent, do any of the foregoing in connection with your own internal machine learning or artificial intelligence system.

Bernstein may use artificial intelligence tools in the preparation of its materials. Any such materials are reviewed by Bernstein's research analysts prior to publication.

This report has been prepared for information purposes only and is based on current public information that we consider reliable, but the entities noted herein do not warrant or represent (express or implied) as to the sources of information or data contained herein are accurate, complete, not misleading or as to its fitness for the purpose intended even though the entities noted herein rely on reputable or trustworthy data providers, it should not be relied upon as such. Opinions expressed are the author(s)' current opinions as of the date appearing on the material only and we do not undertake to advise you of any change in the reported information or in the opinions herein.

Any references to Societe Generale herein are purely factual, based upon publicly available information, and included for comparative purposes only. They do not constitute an opinion or recommendation with respect to the securities of Societe Generale.

This publication was prepared and issued by the entity referred to herein for distribution to eligible counterparties or professional clients. The information in this report is intended for general circulation and does not constitute an offer to buy or sell any security, investment, legal or tax advice nor a personal recommendation, as defined by any of the aforementioned regulators. It does not take into account the particular investment objectives, financial situations, or needs of individual investors. The report has not been reviewed by any of the aforementioned regulators and does not represent any official recommendation from the aforementioned regulators. The investments referred to herein may not be suitable for you. Investors must make their own investment decisions in consultation with advice sought from a financial adviser regarding the suitability of the investment product, taking into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs of any recipient of the recommendation, before the recipient makes a commitment to purchase the investment product.

The analysis contained herein is based on numerous assumptions. Different assumptions could result in materially different results. The information in this report does not constitute, or form part of, any offer to sell or issue, or any offer to purchase or subscribe for shares, or to induce engagement in any other investment activity. The value of any securities or financial instruments mentioned in this report may fluctuate subject to market conditions. Information about past performance of an investment is not necessarily a guide to, indicative of, or assurance of future performance. Estimates of future performance mentioned by the research analyst in this report are based on assumptions that may not be realized due to unforeseen factors like market volatility/fluctuation. In relation to securities or financial instruments denominated in a foreign currency other than the clients' home currency, movements in exchange rates will have an effect on the value, either favorable or unfavorable. Before acting on any recommendations in this report, recipients should consider the appropriateness of investing in the subject securities or financial instruments mentioned in this report and, if necessary, seek independent professional advice.

The securities described herein may not be eligible for sale in all jurisdictions or to certain categories of investors where that permission profile is not consistent with the licenses held by the entities noted herein. This document is for distribution only as may be permitted by law. It is not directed to, or intended for distribution to or use by, any person or entity who is a citizen or resident of or located in any locality, state, country or other jurisdiction where such distribution, publication, availability or use would be contrary to law or regulation or would subject the entities noted herein to any regulation or licensing requirement within such jurisdiction.

Source: Bloomberg Index Services Limited. BLOOMBERG® is a trademark and service mark of Bloomberg Finance L.P. and its affiliates (collectively "Bloomberg"). Bloomberg or Bloomberg's licensors own all proprietary rights in the Bloomberg Indices. Neither Bloomberg nor Bloomberg's licensors approves or endorses this material, or guarantees the accuracy or completeness of any information herein, or makes any warranty, express or implied, as to the results to be obtained therefrom and, to the maximum extent allowed by law, neither shall have any liability or responsibility for injury or damages arising in connection therewith.

No part of this material may be reproduced, distributed or transmitted or otherwise made available without prior consent of the entities noted herein. Copyright Bernstein Institutional Services LLC Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A., Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited and Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社). All rights reserved. The trademarks and service marks contained herein are the property of their respective owners. Any unauthorized use or disclosure is strictly prohibited. The entities noted herein may pursue legal action if the unauthorized use results in any defamation and/or reputational risk to the entities noted herein and research published under the Bernstein and Autonomous brands.